Communication Skills

The Communication Process

Sender — the person who starts the message

Message — verbal or non-verbal, explicit or implicit

Channel — the medium: spoken words, written text, gestures, or visuals

Receiver — the person the message is meant for

Feedback — understanding, agreement, disagreement, or any other response

Noise — anything that interferes: distractions, language and culture gaps, or bias

Communication Styles

Assertive — direct and respectful; clear, and open to hearing other views

Aggressive — dominates, ignores others, and uses hostile or confrontational words

Passive — avoids conflict, hesitant, and struggles to set boundaries

Passive-aggressive — indirect: sarcasm, small insults, or sulking instead of saying it

Diplomatic — keeps the peace, chooses words carefully, and looks for compromise

Collaborative — cooperation, active listening, and a solution both sides accept

Non-verbal — body language, facial expressions, gestures, and tone of voice

Communication Strategy

Define objectives — specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, time-bound

Identify your audience — their needs, preferences, and how they like to be reached

Craft key messages — consistent, compelling, and easy to understand

Select channels — meetings, email, WeChat, written notice, or face to face

Set a timeline — with clear milestones and deadlines

Monitor and evaluate — collect feedback, track KPIs, and adjust as you go

Make it two-way — invite questions and responses from your audience

Consider culture and diversity — the same words can land differently

Discussion

Which of these styles is closest to your own? Give a recent example.

When do you switch styles — with your boss, your team, or a client?

Have you ever worked with an aggressive communicator? How did you handle it?

Is being diplomatic always better than being direct?

When did a message you sent online get misunderstood? What went wrong?

How do you give bad news to a client without losing them?

What do you do when a meeting keeps going off topic?

How does culture change the way people say no at work?

What is the hardest conversation you have had at work?

Who in your team communicates best, and what makes them good at it?